

Laptop Troubleshooting Guide

Technical Support | All SmartTech Laptop Models

This guide provides step-by-step troubleshooting procedures for common issues encountered with SmartTech laptop computers. It is intended for both end-users and technical support staff.

Before contacting SmartTech Support, please work through the relevant section of this guide. Most common issues can be resolved without a service visit.

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1. Power & Boot Issues

1.1 Laptop Won't Turn On

- Ensure the power adapter is firmly connected to both the laptop and a working wall outlet.
- Check the charging LED — if no light, try a different power outlet or adapter.
- Hold the Power button for 10 seconds to perform a hard reset.
- Remove any connected external devices (USB drives, monitors) and retry.
- If the battery is removable, remove it, hold Power for 15 seconds, reinsert, and retry.
- If issue persists, contact SmartTech Support — possible motherboard or battery failure.

1.2 Laptop Turns On But Doesn't Boot

- Listen for beep codes during startup — refer to beep code table in Appendix A.
- Press F12 (or Fn+F12) during startup to access the Boot Menu.
- Ensure the correct boot device (SSD/HDD) is selected.
- If 'No bootable device found' appears, run the built-in diagnostics (press F2 at startup).
- Run Startup Repair from the SmartTech Recovery Partition (press Alt+F10 at startup).

2. Performance Issues

2.1 Laptop Running Slowly

Follow these steps in order:

- Restart the laptop — do not use Sleep/Hibernate if performance is degraded.
- Open Task Manager (Ctrl+Shift+Esc) and check for high CPU/RAM usage processes.
- Disable unnecessary startup programmes: Task Manager → Startup tab.
- Run Disk Cleanup: Search 'Disk Cleanup' in Start Menu.
- Ensure Windows/macOS is fully updated (Settings → Update & Security).
- Check if the laptop is overheating — clean vents with compressed air.
- Consider upgrading RAM if consistently above 85% usage.

3. Display Issues

3.1 Screen is Black / No Display

- Press Windows + P to cycle through display modes (PC screen only, Extend, Duplicate, etc.).
- Check if an external monitor is connected and inadvertently set as the primary display.
- Increase screen brightness using Fn + Brightness Up key.
- Connect an external monitor — if it works, the internal display or its cable may be faulty.
- Boot into Safe Mode (press F8 during startup) to rule out driver issues.

3.2 Display Flickering

- Update the display driver: Device Manager → Display Adapters → Update Driver.
- Change the screen refresh rate: Display Settings → Advanced Display → Refresh Rate.
- Disable hardware acceleration in your browser if flickering occurs only in browser.
- Test by connecting an external monitor — if stable, the internal panel may need service.

4. Connectivity Issues

Issue	Quick Fix	Advanced Fix
No Wi-Fi networks	Toggle Airplane Mode on/off	Reinstall network adapter driver
Wi-Fi connected, no internet	Forget & reconnect to network	Flush DNS: <code>ipconfig /flushdns</code>
Bluetooth not detected	Toggle Bluetooth off/on	Update Bluetooth driver
USB device not recognised	Try different USB port	Update USB controller driver
HDMI no signal	Unplug/replug HDMI cable	Update display/GPU driver

5. Audio Issues

5.1 No Sound

- Check volume is not muted (Fn + Mute key or volume icon in taskbar).
- Right-click the speaker icon → Open Sound Settings → Ensure correct output device selected.
- Run the Audio Troubleshooter: Settings → System → Sound → Troubleshoot.
- Update audio driver: Device Manager → Sound, video and game controllers.

5.2 Microphone Not Working

- Check Privacy Settings: Settings → Privacy → Microphone → Allow apps to access microphone.
- Select correct microphone in app settings (Teams, Zoom, etc.).
- Test in Sound Recorder app to isolate app-specific vs system-level issue.
- Update microphone/audio driver from Device Manager.

6. When to Contact Support

If you have followed all relevant steps and the issue persists, please contact SmartTech Technical Support. Have the following ready:

- Laptop model number and serial number (found on the label under the device).
- Operating system version.
- Detailed description of the issue and steps already tried.
- Any error codes or messages displayed.

Contact: 1800-SMART-TECH | techsupport@smarttech.com | Live Chat at www.smarttech.com/support